

LATAA Football Academy

SAFEGUARDING POLICY

1. OUR COMMITMENT

LATAA Football Academy is committed to providing a safe, positive, inclusive and enjoyable environment in which all children and young people can participate in football, develop their abilities and reach their potential.

The welfare and protection of children is our highest priority. LATAA Football Academy recognises that safeguarding is everyone's responsibility and that every child has the right to be protected from abuse, neglect, exploitation, bullying, discrimination and harm.

We are committed to creating an environment where children feel safe, respected, valued and listened to, and where they are encouraged to speak openly if something is worrying them.

LATAA Football Academy will take all safeguarding concerns seriously and will respond to them promptly and appropriately.

2. PURPOSE OF THIS POLICY

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Protect children and young people who participate in LATAA Football Academy activities.
- Promote the welfare, safety and wellbeing of all children.
- Provide clear procedures for responding to safeguarding concerns.
- Ensure that coaches, staff, volunteers and other adults understand their safeguarding responsibilities.
- Promote safer recruitment and appropriate DBS checks.
- Establish clear standards of behaviour for coaches, players, parents and visitors.
- Ensure concerns are reported to the appropriate safeguarding authority when necessary.
- Provide a framework for working with parents, carers, The FA, County FA and statutory agencies.

This policy applies to everyone involved with LATAA Football Academy, including directors, coaches, staff, volunteers, mentors, sessional workers, self-employed contractors and any other person working directly with children.

3. SAFEGUARDING CONTACTS

LATAA Football Academy Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL) who will have overall responsibility for safeguarding arrangements.

Designated Safeguarding Lead:

Name: Micah Hyde

Telephone: 07860 136028

Email: micahhyde@mac.com

County FA Safeguarding Contact:

Helen Hever (Safeguarding Manager): helen.hever@essexfa.com / 01245 393098

Local Authority Children's Social Care:

London Borough of Barking and Dagenham is 020 8227 3811, with 020 8215 3000 used for out-of-hours emergencies

Emergency:

Police / Emergency Services – 999

The FA Safeguarding Team:

safeguarding@thefa.com

The DSL will not investigate concerns personally where this could interfere with a statutory investigation. Where appropriate, concerns will be referred to the relevant safeguarding authority.

4. COACHES CODE OF CONDUCT

Every adult working with LATAA has a responsibility to safeguard children.

Coaches and staff must:

- Put children's welfare first.
- Treat every child with dignity and respect.
- Follow LATAA's safeguarding policies and procedures.
- Maintain appropriate professional boundaries.
- Report concerns promptly.
- Never promise a child that information will be kept secret.
- Never investigate an allegation themselves.
- Never dismiss or ignore a safeguarding concern.

5. SAFER RECRUITMENT

LATAA Football Academy is committed to safer recruitment.

Before a coach or other relevant adult begins working with children, LATAA will, where appropriate:

- Obtain and check suitable references.

- Verify identity.
- Check relevant qualifications and coaching certificates.
- Complete the appropriate DBS check where the role is eligible.
- Check safeguarding training requirements.
- Confirm the person's suitability to work with children.
- Consider any safeguarding concerns arising during recruitment.

Where a role requires an Enhanced DBS check with a Children's Barred List check, LATAA will ensure that the appropriate check is completed through the correct DBS process.

DBS checks will not be treated as a substitute for safer recruitment. A DBS check is one part of the overall safeguarding process.

6. SAFEGUARDING TRAINING

LATAA Football Academy coaches and relevant staff undertake appropriate safeguarding training.

Coaches working directly with children complete relevant safeguarding training and maintain their knowledge through regular updates.

LATAA encourage coaches to undertake relevant FA safeguarding training and other appropriate safeguarding education.

Safeguarding training covers:

- Recognising signs and indicators of abuse.
- Responding to disclosures.
- Reporting safeguarding concerns.
- Professional boundaries.
- Appropriate behaviour.
- Online safety.
- Bullying and discrimination.
- The role of the Designated Safeguarding Lead.

7. PARENT/CARER CODE OF CONDUCT

At LATAA Football Academy, we want every child to enjoy football in a safe, positive, inclusive and supportive environment.

Parents and carers play an important role in creating this environment. We ask all parents and carers to support their child, our coaches and other players by following Parent/Carer Code of Conduct.

The welfare and wellbeing of every player must always come first.

- Supporting My Child
- Respectful Behaviour
- Safeguarding

- Communication with LATAA
- Feedback and Complaints
- Social media and online Behaviour
- Photography and video
- Arrival, collection and attendance
- Player welfare and health
- Equality, Diversity and inclusion
- Alcohol, drugs and smoking
- Respecting LATAA's coaching environment

8. REPORTING SAFEGUARDING CONCERNS

Any safeguarding concern must be reported to the LATAA Designated Safeguarding Lead as soon as possible.

If the concern involves the DSL, the concern must be directly to the appropriate external safeguarding authority.

If a child is in immediate danger, the Police should be contacted by calling **999**.

For non-emergency safeguarding concerns, the appropriate local authority Children's Social Care service should be contacted.

Concerns relating to football safeguarding may also be reported through the appropriate County FA or The FA safeguarding processes.

The FA states that safeguarding concerns in football should be referred through the relevant club, league or County FA safeguarding route, with concerns also able to be referred directly to The FA safeguarding team. (www.thefa.com)

9. CONFIDENTIALITY AND INFORMATION SHARING

Safeguarding information will be handled sensitively and confidentially.

However, confidentiality will not prevent LATAA from sharing information where this is necessary to protect a child from harm.

Information will be shared only with appropriate individuals or organisations who need to know, in accordance with safeguarding requirements and applicable data protection legislation.

LATAA will maintain appropriate safeguarding records and ensure they are stored securely.

10. PHOTOGRAPHY, VIDEO AND SOCIAL MEDIA

LATAA recognises the importance of protecting children's privacy and safety when using photographs, video and social media.

LATAA will:

- Obtain appropriate parental or guardian consent before using images of children.
- Explain how images may be used.
- Avoid publishing unnecessary personal information.
- Ensure photographs and videos are appropriate.
- Never publish images that could embarrass, humiliate or place a child at risk.
- Follow appropriate guidance when filming or photographing children during football activities.

Coaches and staff must not use personal devices to take inappropriate or unauthorised photographs or videos of children.

11. BULLYING AND DISCRIMINATION

LATAA Football Academy has zero tolerance for bullying, harassment, discrimination or abusive behaviour.

This includes behaviour based on:

- Race or nationality.
- Religion or belief.
- Disability.
- Sex or gender.
- Sexual orientation.
- Age.
- Appearance.
- Ability or footballing level.
- Any other protected or personal characteristic.

Bullying may be verbal, physical, emotional, social or online.

Any concerns should be reported to a coach or the DSL.

LATAA will respond promptly and fairly and will take appropriate action to protect children.

12. ONLINE SAFETY

LATAA recognises that safeguarding risks can occur online.

Coaches, staff and volunteers must maintain appropriate boundaries when communicating digitally with children.

LATAA will promote safe and responsible use of:

- Social media.
- Messaging applications.
- Email.

- Online gaming.
- Video platforms.
- Digital communication.

Any online safeguarding concern involving a LATAA player should be reported to the DSL.

13. ALLEGATIONS AGAINST COACHES OR STAFF

Any allegation that a coach, staff member, volunteer or other adult working with LATAA has harmed or may have harmed a child will be taken seriously.

The person receiving the allegation must immediately report it to the DSL or the appropriate senior person.

The individual concerned should not be confronted about the allegation or asked to provide an explanation before appropriate safeguarding advice has been obtained.

LATAA will refer matters to the appropriate statutory agencies, The FA or County FA where required.

LATAA will cooperate fully with any investigation.

Where necessary, appropriate interim measures may be taken to protect children while an investigation is ongoing.

14. HEALTH, SAFETY AND EMERGENCIES

LATAA will take reasonable steps to provide a safe environment for all participants.

This includes appropriate arrangements for:

- Medical emergencies.
- Collection arrangements.
- Extreme weather.
- Safe use of facilities.
- Emergency evacuation.

LATAA will ensure that coaches understand the emergency procedures relevant to the facilities where sessions are delivered.

15. RECORD KEEPING

LATAA will maintain appropriate records relating to safeguarding, including:

- Safeguarding concerns.
- Referrals.
- Actions taken.
- DBS checks.

- Safeguarding training.
- Safer recruitment records.

Safeguarding records will be stored securely and accessed only by authorised individuals.

16. POLICY REVIEW

This policy will be reviewed at least annually or sooner if:

- There are significant changes to legislation.
- There are changes to FA safeguarding requirements.
- LATAA changes its activities or operating arrangements.
- A safeguarding incident identifies a need for policy improvement.

The policy will be reviewed by the LATAA management team and updated where necessary.

17. POLICY STATEMENT

LATAA Football Academy is committed to ensuring that football is a safe, enjoyable and positive experience for every child.

We believe that safeguarding is everyone's responsibility.

We will listen to children, take concerns seriously, act promptly and work with parents, carers, football authorities and statutory agencies to protect children from harm.

LATAA Football Academy will always put the welfare and safety of children first.

Date Adopted: 3 August 2026

Review Date: 3 August 2027